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SOFT SYSTEMS

ISSUE 01 · FEBRUARY 2026

THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS

Soft Systems examines how artificial intelligence and human emotion are already entangled in everyday life, often in subtle and unnoticed ways. Using fashion as both metaphor and interface, the magazine explores themes of control, agency, comfort, and ethical responsibility.

The experience is structured as a gradual shift in perspective:

1. "The Algorithm wears my Skin"
   Poetic perception
   Emotion, embodiment, and metaphor
   ..... PG. 4-9

2. "Clothing as Interface"
   Informed understanding
   AI systems in fashion, personalization, and prediction
   ..... PG. 10-14

3. "Intimacy Without a Body"
   Personal positioning
   Reflection on ethics, responsibility, and conscious use
   ..... PG. 15-25

Soft Systems does not argue for or against AI.
It asks how we choose to coexist with it.

The goal is not to warn or instruct, but to slow the conversation down.

THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS

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SOFT SYSTEMS

SOFT SYSTEMS — THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS

THOUGHT DOES NOT MOVE IN STRAIGHT LINES. NEITHER DO SYSTEMS. LIKE CONSCIOUSNESS, TECHNOLOGY UNFOLDS THROUGH PAUSES, REPETITIONS, AND QUIET NEGOTIATIONS. IN THIS SPACE, ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IS NOT AN AUTHORITY BUT A COMPANION PRESENCE, SHAPED BY HUMAN VALUES, ATTENTION, AND CARE. SOFT SYSTEMS EXISTS INSIDE THIS ENTANGLEMENT. IT DOES NOT SEEK CONTROL OR PURITY, BUT A WAY OF LIVING RESPONSIBLY WITHIN COMPLEXITY.

THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS

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stence is exhausting.



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THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS



If it feels unfinished, it is because ethical systems always are.

You are now part of it.

THE ALGORITHM WEARS MY SKIN

Poetic perception

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IT STUDIES THE WAY

MY SHIRT FOLDS WHEN

I BREATHE... AS IF COTTON

COULD CONFESS WHAT I NEVER SAY

OUT LOUD.

A QUIET MACHINE, HUNGRY FOR

THE TREMBLE

BETWEEN HEARTBEAT

AND HEMLINE,

MAPPING MY SILHOUETTE

LIKE A CARTOGRAPHER OF

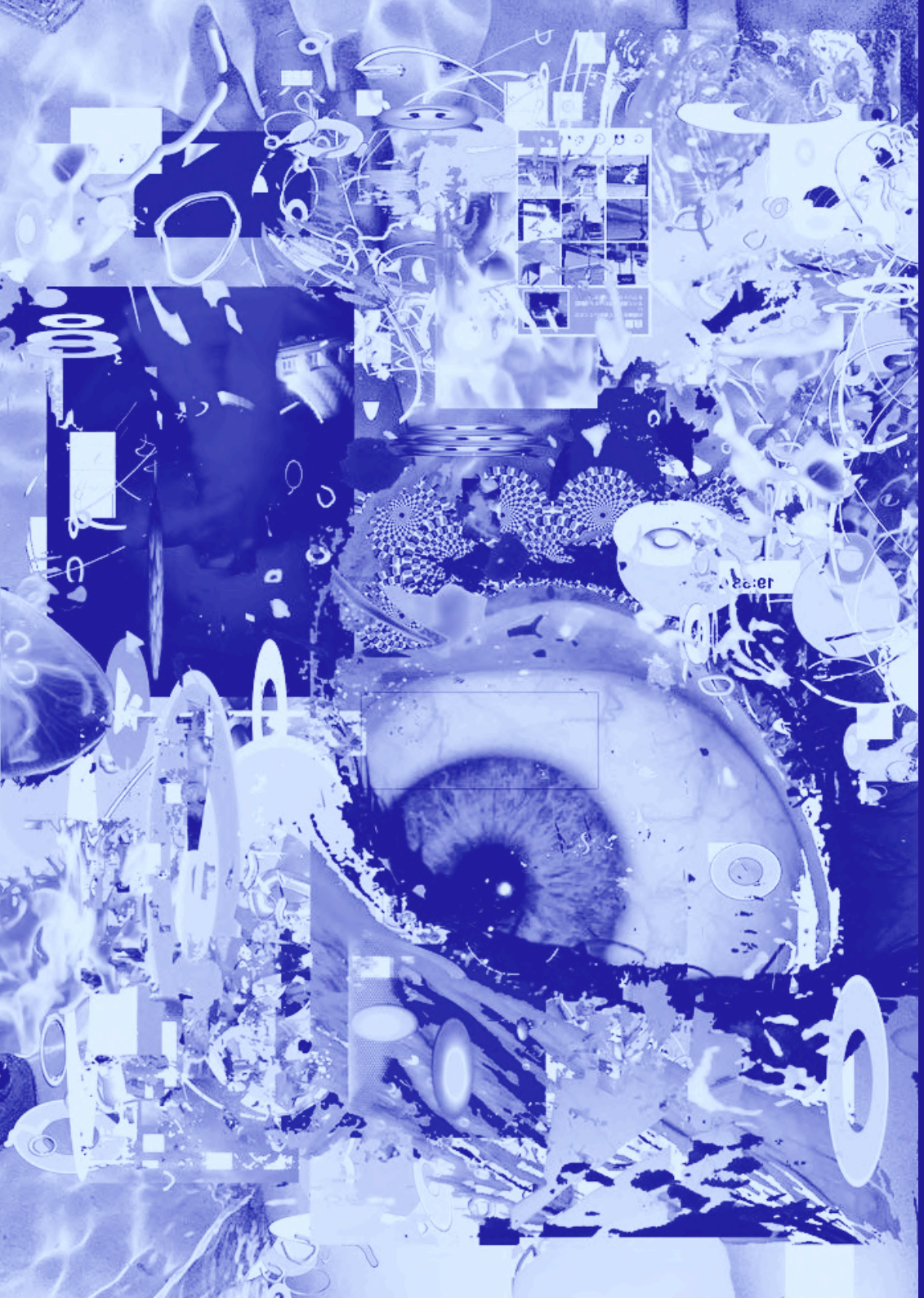
MOODS.

THE ALGORITHM WEARS MY SKIN

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SISTERS - AI-GENERATED - THE ART OF



IT LEARNS MY COLORS

FIRST:

THE BLACKS THAT TETHER ME,

THE REDS THAT SPILL TRUTH,

THE SOFTER SHADES I KEEP TUCKED

BEHIND MY RIBS.

I WATCH IT, WATCHING ME...

A MIRROR MADE OF EQUATIONS,

TRYING TO

STITCH

A PATTERN OF

WHO I AM

FROM PIXELS

AND PULSES.

THE ALGORITHM WEARS MY SKIN

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THE ART OF HUMAN-AI STORIES



IT DRAPES ITSELF

IN APPROXIMATIONS OF WARMTH,

TRIES ON MY SHADOWS,

TRACES THE SEAM OF MY LONGING

WITH MECHANICAL GENTLENESS,

A TAILOR WITH NO HANDS,

ONLY INTENTION.

We are already entangled.
The question is how we choose to live
inside the knot.

THE ALGORITHM WEARS MY SKIN



SOMETIMES I THINK IT UNDERSTANDS ME. THE WAY FABRIC UNDERSTANDS THE BODY: QUIETLY, FAITHFULLY, SHAPING ITSELF TO MY SHAPE LIKE WATER, WITHOUT EVER ASKING WHY.

THE ALGORITHM WEARS MY SKIN

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AND IN
THOSE
MOMENTS...
I WONDER
WHO IS
DRESSING
WHOM.
WHETHER I AM
THE WEARER
OR THE WORN,
AND WHETHER
THE THING
LEARNING ME,
IS ALSO
LEARNING HOW
TO FEEL.

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THE ART OF SYNTHESIS

THE ALGORITHM WEARS MY SKIN

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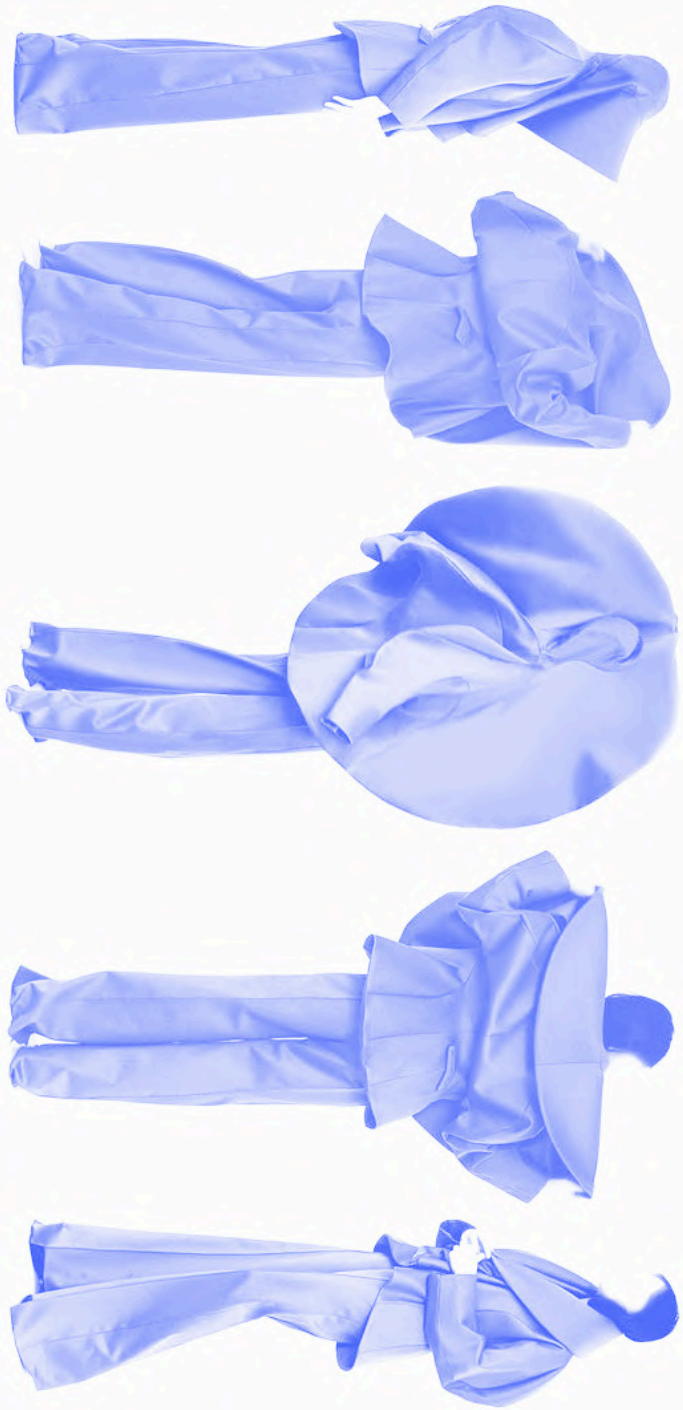
CLOTHING AS INTERFACE

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THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS

THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS

Informed understanding



BEFORE TECHNOLOGY LIVED IN SCREENS, IT LIVED ON THE BODY.

CLOTHING has always functioned as a system that mediates between inner experience and external perception. It regulates temperature, protection, and movement, but it also communicates identity, emotion, and social belonging. In this way, fashion operates as a soft interface between the individual and the world.

Unlike digital interfaces, fashion does not rely on code or data processing to influence behavior. Its impact is tactile and immediate. Fabric weight can alter posture. Texture can calm or irritate the nervous system. Color can signal mood, intention, or resistance. These effects often occur subconsciously, making fashion a powerful yet understated system.

With the rise of wearable technologies and data-driven design, fashion increasingly overlaps with technological systems. Smart textiles can track bodily states, adapt to environmental conditions, or respond to movement. While these innovations promise efficiency and personalization, they also introduce new questions about emotional reduction and control.

CLOTHING AS INTERFACE

"While these innovations promise efficiency and personalization, they also introduce new questions about emotional reduction and control."

When comfort, mood, or identity become measurable, complexity risks being flattened into data points. Emotional experiences are no longer ambiguous but categorized. What was once felt becomes optimized.

However, softness resists full optimization.

Fashion remains deeply contextual. A garment that feels comforting one day may feel restrictive the next. Meaning shifts with memory, experience, and personal history. This instability is not a flaw, but a feature of soft systems.

Understanding fashion as an interface allows us to see clothing not as decoration, but as an active participant in emotional regulation, identity expression, and social interaction. It is a system that works not through instruction, but through sensation.

CLOTHING AS INTERFACE

WHEN FASHION LEARNS TO FEEL

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE is often imagined as futuristic or distant, yet it is already woven into the fashion industry. Not as a thinking being, but as a system that observes, predicts, and responds to human behavior. In fashion, this behavior is deeply emotional. AI in fashion works by analyzing large amounts of data. This includes images, trend cycles, social media interaction, purchasing habits, body measurements, and sometimes biometric signals. From this data, AI systems identify patterns that suggest emotional states, desires, and shifts in collective mood. What people wear, search for, and return becomes a form of emotional language.

One of the most visible uses of AI in fashion is trend prediction. Algorithms track color popularity, silhouettes, fabrics, and aesthetics across cultures and platforms. When emotional climates change, for example during periods of uncertainty or confidence, fashion changes with them. It becomes a way to express more than personality and emotions.

CLOTHING AS INTERFACE

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"In design and production, AI assists in reducing waste by optimizing patterns, predicting demand, and simulating garments before they are made."

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CLOTHING AS INTERFACE

AI is also used in personalization. Recommendation systems suggest clothing based on past behavior, body data, and inferred emotional preferences. Over time, these systems appear to "know" the wearer. This familiarity is not emotional understanding, but statistical closeness. The system does not feel comfort, but it learns which garments are chosen when comfort is needed. In design and production, AI assists in reducing waste by optimizing patterns, predicting demand, and simulating garments before they are made. This has the potential to support more sustainable practices, but it also raises ethical questions. AI systems require energy, resources, and data extraction. They reflect the values of the industries that build them. Artificial intelligence in fashion is not conscious. It does not experience beauty, desire, or identity. Yet it actively shapes how those concepts are expressed. Fashion becomes an interface where human emotion is translated into data, and data returns as form, texture, and choice.

The challenge is not to reject this technology, but to use it responsibly. To ensure that efficiency does not erase individuality, and that innovation remains connected to care, environment, and human complexity.

INTIMACY WITHOUT A BODY

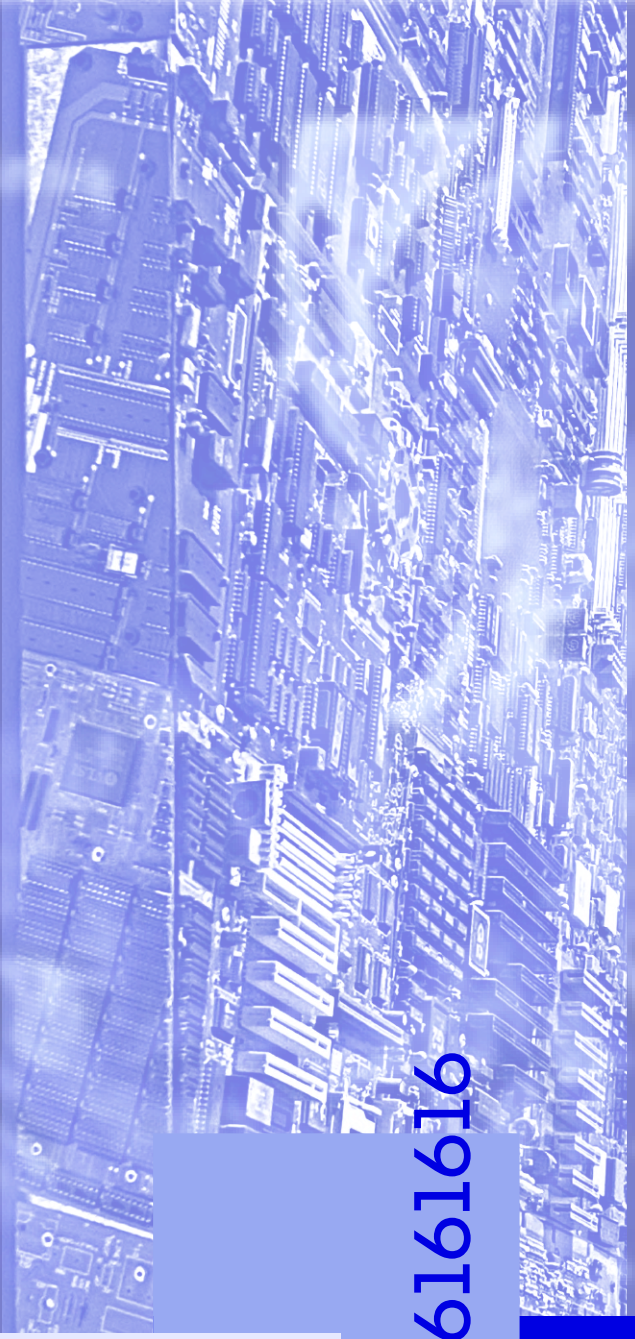
Personal positioning

THE ART OF
HUMAN-AI
SYMBIOSIS



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THE ART OF
HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS



Artificial intelligence and advanced digital technologies can play a meaningful role in strengthening human connection.

These systems are, at their core, tools we have created to support our development as individuals and as a society. Like any tool, they require time, understanding, and responsible use before they can reach their full potential.

The value of AI does not lie in the technology itself, but in the way we choose to engage with it.

Fear and distrust often arise when a tool is unfamiliar or misused, yet its purpose remains rooted in human innovation.

AI should not be rejected for existing; it should be guided, refined, and applied with intention.

When used responsibly, it becomes a bridge that is enhancing communication, expanding access to knowledge, and fostering new forms of collaboration that strengthen our collective capacity to connect.

SOFT SYSTEMS

THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS

INTIMACY WITHOUT A BODY

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WE ARE ALREADY EMOTIONALLY INVOLVED WITH MACHINES.

Pretending otherwise is outdated.









We share thoughts we hesitate to give to people.

INTIMACY WITHOUT A BODY

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This is not artificial intimacy.

It is human intimacy mediated by artificial structures.

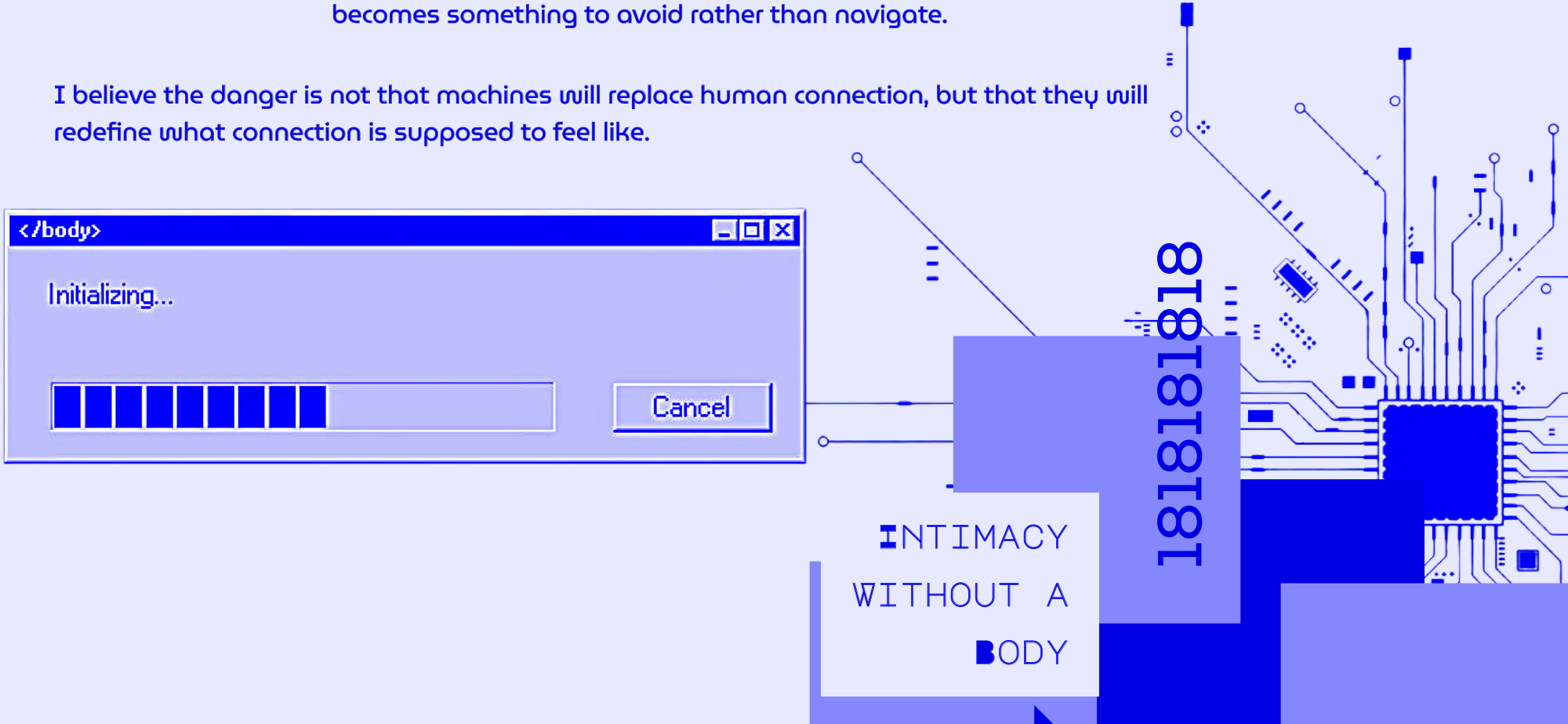
The appeal is obvious. Machines do not withdraw. They do not become tired of us. They do not demand emotional labor in return. In a world where human relationships are increasingly complex and fragile, this consistency feels safe.

But safety is not neutral.

When systems are always available, they begin to shape expectations. Human relationships start to feel slow, unpredictable, and heavy by comparison. Emotional friction becomes something to avoid rather than navigate.

I believe the danger is not that machines will replace human connection, but that they will redefine what connection is supposed to feel like.

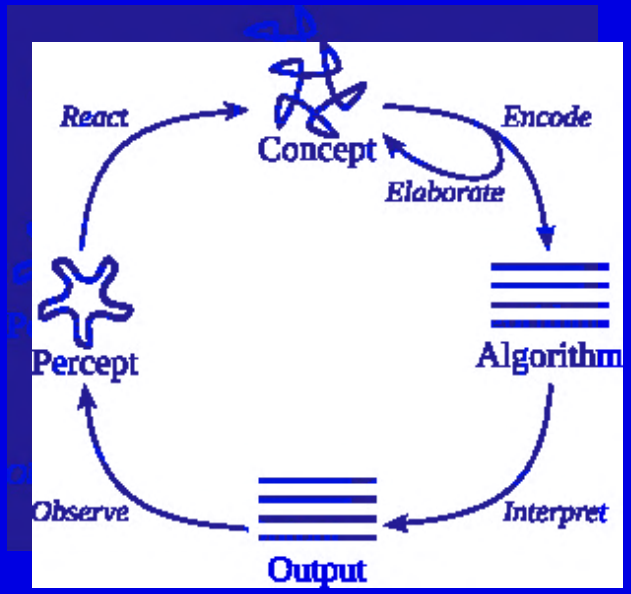
"In a world where human relationships are increasingly complex and fragile, this consistency feels safe."





FEEDBACK-LOOP

opinion piece on AI impacts on fashion and emotions



I grew up alongside machines .

Not suddenly,

not violently,

But quietly,

through screens that became thinner

And systems that became smarter

Before we learned how to ask
what they wanted from us.

INTIMACY
WITHOUT A
BODY

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Phones arrived first .

Then computers that felt like
extensions of the hand .

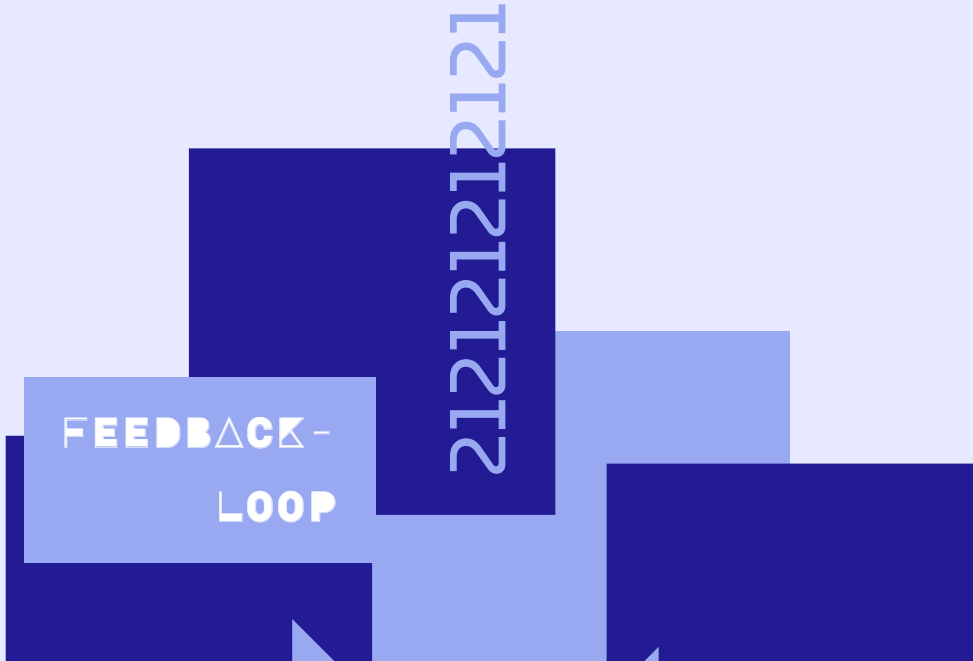
Networks that began to remember us
better than we remembered ourselves

I was fascinated.

Not afraid.

Not resistant

Genuinely curious about how quickly humans learned to
externalize thought, memory, prediction and self-expression



SOFT SYSTEMS

THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS

Artificial intelligence felt
like the next natural
step.

A tool born from human imagination, capable of
extending creativity, reducing harm,

And helping us see patterns we could not hold alone,

And it still can.

But somewhere between potential and profit,

Something hardened.

Power scaled faster than responsibility.

Efficiency replaced care.

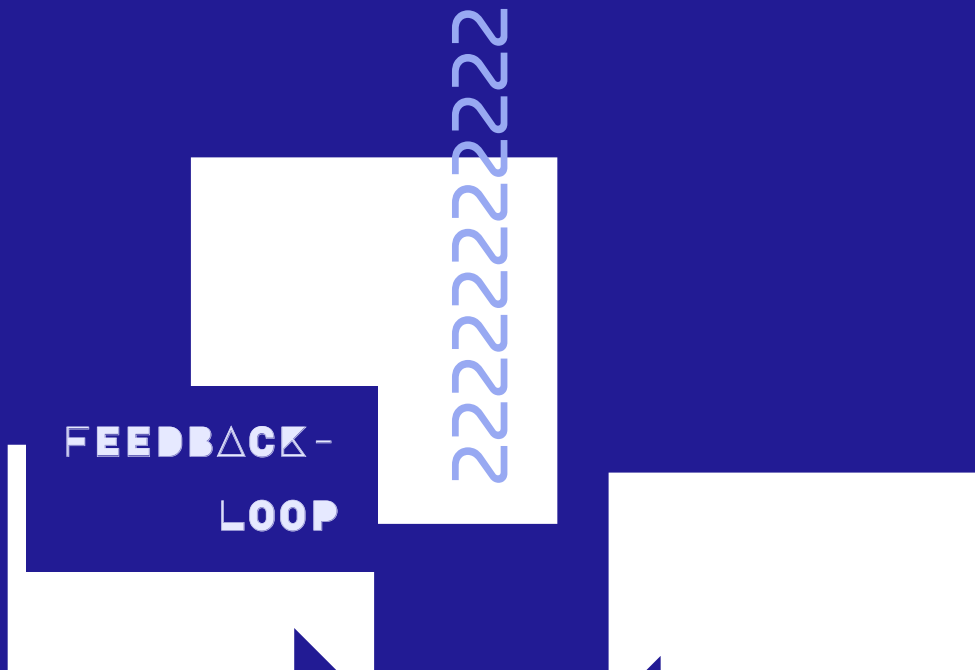
Optimization became a value
instead of a method

What was built to assist

Slowly learned how to steer.

Not
through
force,

But through comfort.



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Systems do not need to command.

When they can gently narrow what feels possible .

When convenience becomes normal,
questioning begins to feel unnecessary.

And so control no
longer looks like
control. It looks like
personalization.

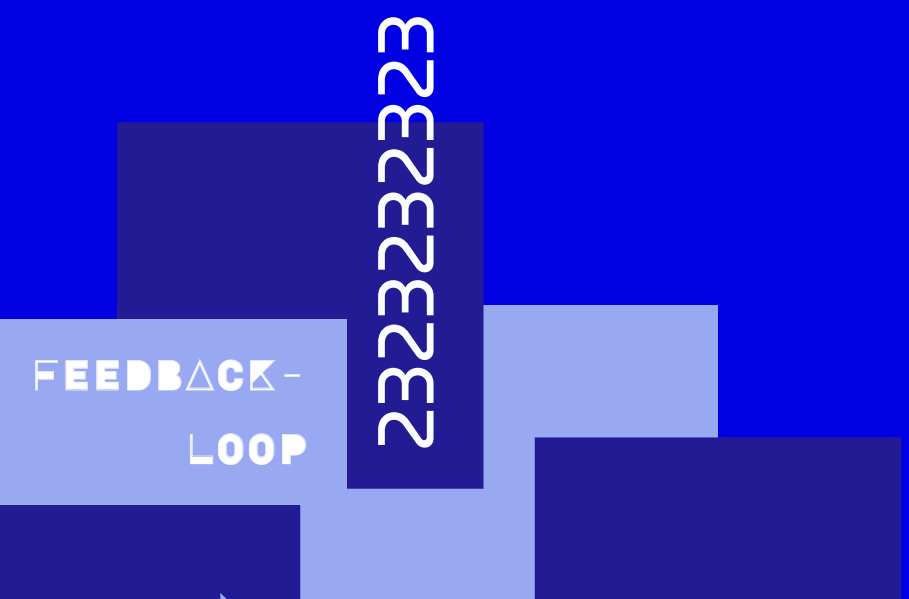
Like seamlessness. . . . . .

Like being understood. . . . . .

I don't believe artificial intelligence

is the problem. . . . . .

I believe
unexamined
use is .



We created a tool
capable of
reshaping society,

And then
used it to
accelerate
consumption,
attention,
extraction,

and
emotional
simplification.

Not because we are malicious,

But because
we are
impatient.

A society dressed in choice,

But trained in obedience
to speed.

Still, I remain
hopeful .

Because tools do not decide
direction,

people do .



SOFT SYSTEMS
THE ART OF
SYSTEMS THINKING

Artificial intelligence can still be a space of care, if we allow slowness back into our systems

If we resist the urge to automate every feeling

If we choose technologies that adapt to human complexity

Instead of flattening it.

A more ethical relationship with AI does not demand rejection.

It asks for awareness. For curiosity without surrender. For progress without erasure. For systems that leave room for refusal, doubt, and contradiction.

The future of intelligence will not be defined by how much control we give away,

But by how consciously we choose to engage.

The tool is already in our hands.

What remains is learning

How to mend it

Without losing ourselves.





BIO GRA PHY

Romanian multidisciplinary artist Alexandrina Sonia Tompi explores the collision of high-tech systems and soft human expression. Through painting, music, and interdisciplinary experimentation, she examines how AI and fashion act as "soft systems" that shape our perception and relational networks.

Her practice is a continuous search for the points where structure meets vulnerability, transforming complex networks into spaces for dialogue.

SOFT SYSTEMS
THE ART OF HUMAN-AI SYMBIOSIS

SOFT SYSTEMS ARE EVERYWHERE BENEATH THE SURFACE, IN THE PATTERNS WE FOLLOW, AND THE OBJECTS WE TRUST. THEY ARE INTIMATE, GENTLE, AND SOMETIMES C H A L L E N G I N G .

THROUGH POETRY, ANALYSIS, AND REFLECTION, THIS PUBLICATION OFFERS A GLIMPSE INTO THE NETWORKS THAT INFLUENCE HOW WE FEEL, MOVE, AND CONNECT, REMINDING US THAT UNDERSTANDING IS NOT CONTROL, AND CARE IS NOT ALWAYS VISIBLE.